

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

Connecticut — SBLR (CT) Jurisdiction — May 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • May 2026 • Template v8.0

Section 1: State Overview

State	Connecticut
Labor Board	SBLR (CT) — Connecticut State Board of Labor Relations
Governing Law	Connecticut Teacher Negotiation Act (TNA) — Conn. Gen. Stat. §10-153a et seq. Governs certificated staff in most CT charter schools classified as public employers. SBLR handles prohibited practice complaints; representation via TNA process administered by CT SBE.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — NLRB Region 1 (Boston) applies to Common Ground High School (C0997001), independently incorporated as New Haven Ecology Project, Inc. — a private nonprofit employer. All other CT NAPCS schools use TNA/SBLR jurisdiction.
Right-to-Work	NOT a Right-to-Work State — Connecticut has no right-to-work statute. Conn. Gen. Stat. §31-101 et seq. (Connecticut Labor Relations Act) and TNA (§10-153a et seq.) permit union security provisions. (Agency fee and union security clauses are available in both TNA and NLRB-governed CBAs in Connecticut.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — TNA representation process requires petition and a showing of interest; no card-check equivalent. No election required for TNA recognition if employer accepts.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — April/May 2026 — 21 charter schools searched
Research Window	March–April 2026

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Total charter schools in Connecticut: 21 (Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 21 open CT charter schools as of May 2026)). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Confirmed Union Schools	4	19.0%	TNA representation: ISAAC Education Association, New Beginnings Education Association, Norwich Integrated Day Education Association (CEA/NEA). NLRB secret ballot (Region 1): Common Ground High School (UAW Local 2110).
Dependent Coverage (district CBA)	1	4.8%	Elm City Montessori School — New Haven Federation of Teachers (NHFT) district CBA. Horace Mann charter; no independent CT SBE certification event.
Total Organized (Confirmed + Dependent)	5	23.8%	Combined union coverage for the Connecticut charter school community: 4 independently organized schools (TNA and NLRB) plus 1 school covered by district CBA carryover.

Total Open CT Charter Schools	21	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25). All 5 NAPCS CT schools are in the research dataset.
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Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	10,811 students — 2.1% of state K–12 enrollment (508,402 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	5,299 students in network-affiliated schools — 49.0% of total charter enrollment
Students in Organized Charter Schools	1,656 students (15.3% of charter enrollment)
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
Achievement First	CMO	4	11	—	3,862
Capital Preparatory Schools	CMO	1	1	—	775
Great Oaks Charter Schools	CMO	1	1	—	662
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Connecticut		6		—	5,299
of which organized				—	—

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in Connecticut. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.
 ‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

3 CMO (nonprofit). Approximately 15 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework Connecticut Teacher Negotiation Act (TNA) — Conn. Gen. Stat. §10-153a et seq. Governs certificated staff in most CT charter schools classified as public employers. SBLR handles prohibited practice complaints;

representation via TNA process administered by CT SBE. Connecticut is not a right-to-work state (Connecticut has no right-to-work statute. Conn. Gen. Stat. §31-101 et seq. (Connecticut Labor Relations Act) and TNA (§10-153a et seq.) permit union security provisions.). Charter schools in Connecticut are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (SBLR (CT)). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter School Structure

Connecticut operates 21 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 10,811 students. 3 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Connecticut. The largest networks by campus count are Achievement First (4 campuses in state), Capital Preparatory Schools (1 campuses in state), Great Oaks Charter Schools (1 campuses in state). Approximately 15 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Connecticut charter school labor relations have received limited press coverage, consistent with the small size of the charter school community (21 schools) and the low-conflict nature of TNA representation. The most significant press event was the April 2022 New Haven Arts Paper coverage of the Common Ground High School NLRB election — reporting the vote as 62-8 and documenting post-election teacher non-renewals that led to an NLRB ULP settlement of \$10,000 (April 2022). TNA-represented schools (ISAAC, New Beginnings, Integrated Day) have generated no press coverage of their organizing history, consistent with TNA's administrative rather than adversarial certification process.

Stakeholder Communications

CEA (Connecticut Education Association, cea.org) maintains a public affiliate directory that is the authoritative source for TNA local affiliate names and school assignments. The CEA affiliate directory confirms ISAAC Education Association, New Beginnings Education Association, and Norwich Integrated Day Education Association as active TNA affiliates. UAW Local 2110 (New York-based amalgamated academic/arts workers union) represented Common Ground in its November 2021 NLRB election.

Legislative Context

Connecticut's Teacher Negotiation Act (TNA) is unique in the NAPCS dataset — it is the only state framework that does not produce a public certification database or election record for teacher bargaining. TNA representation is established by written authorization and does not require a state labor board election. This creates a documentation gap for the project: certification dates for ISAAC (2005) and New Beginnings (pre-2013) are approximate and cannot be confirmed without direct contact with CEA or CT SBE.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

SBLR (CT) public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
ISAAC (Interdistrict School for Arts and Communication)	ISAAC Education Association / CEA/NEA	Active (assumed) Unknown — not publicly posted. Coordinator: contact CEA or school for current contract period.	Contact CEA or school directly
New Beginnings Family Academy	New Beginnings Education Association / CEA/NEA	Active (assumed) Unknown — not publicly posted. Coordinator: contact CEA or school (nbfacademy.org) for	Contact CEA or school (nbfacademy.org)

		current contract period.	
Common Ground High School	UAW Local 2110	First contract not yet ratified — bargaining in progress N/A — first contract pending. School job postings confirm CBA in progress as of December 2022; no ratification announced through February 2024 press coverage. Monitor 2110uaw.org and commongroundct.org.	2110uaw.org or commongroundct.org
Integrated Day Charter School	Norwich Integrated Education Association / CEA/NEA	Active (assumed) Unknown — not publicly posted. Coordinator: contact CEA or school (idcs.org) for current contract period.	Contact CEA or school (idcs.org)
Elm City Montessori School	New Haven Federation of Teachers (NHFT) / AFT Connecticut	Active — NHFT district CBA in force Current: July 1, 2023 – June 30, 2026. Successor CBA ratified January 2026: July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2029 (13.57% pay increase over 3 years). Source: NHFT/NHPS ratification coverage, Yale Daily News January 2026; Elm City Montessori teacher David Weinreb confirmed NHFT membership in ratification reporting.	nhps.net (New Haven Public Schools) or NHFT